

New JETRO Regional and Analysis Report Notification (October 1, 2026 Issue)

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Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We are pleased to deliver the latest information on JETRO's regional and analysis reports, which examine the political and economic trends of major countries and regions worldwide from JETRO's unique perspective. We hope you will find these reports useful.

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****[Special Feature] Business Opportunities in Latin America! Expanding Global South Consumer Markets****

The combined GDP of six major Latin American countries—Mexico, Brazil, Argentina, Chile, Peru, and Colombia—totals approximately \$5.6 trillion, surpassing ASEAN. With per capita GDP exceeding \$10,000, this is a promising market with expanding purchasing power. While Japan's cultural appeal and diverse cultural backgrounds are strengths, Japanese companies' market entry has been limited due to high tariffs and non-tariff barriers. Recently, the constraints of distance have weakened due to the expansion of e-commerce and m-commerce, and as deregulation advances in some countries, business opportunities for Japanese companies are expanding. This special feature analyzes and presents a wide range of information on consumption and industrial trends, policies, and their impact on companies in major Latin American nations.

<Special Feature Articles> *More articles will be added.

◇Latin American Consumer Markets

◇Brazil's Consumer Market (1) Financial Inclusion Supported by Pix and Fintech

◇How Smartphones and Digital Finance Are Changing the Urban Landscape (Peru)

****[Special Feature] Business Cases in Africa <Additional Articles>****

In Africa, not only large corporations with networks and financial resources, but also startups with cutting-edge technology and small and medium-sized enterprises in various fields are finding diverse business opportunities. Additionally, various approaches are possible for each country, including partnerships with third-country companies and local businesses that have already proven track records. This special feature has presented specific businesses in Africa, including developments before and after the 9th Tokyo International Conference on African Development (TICAD9) in fiscal years 2024-2025. In fiscal year 2026, with an eye toward the next TICAD10, we will focus on company interviews to comprehensively cover business cases of Japanese companies and local

enterprises, exploring new business opportunities, possibilities for collaboration, and hints for business expansion that emerge locally.

<Additional Articles>

■ Japanese Company Cases

◇ TOKYO08 GLOBAL Tackles Agricultural Challenges with Local Production Model for Microbial Fertilizers

■ African Expansion from Across Japan

◇ Ito Electrical & Medical Instruments Opens the Egyptian Market through Local Distributor Strategy

**[Special Feature] The Transforming Global Semiconductor Ecosystem <Additional Articles> **

Semiconductor ecosystems around the world are showing active movement. As the semiconductor market is expected to reach \$1 trillion by 2030, chip makers and related companies are accelerating investments on an unprecedented scale. Major countries are entering a phase of investing massive budgets to attract investment. With new elements of economic security and geopolitics added to the mix, signs of change are appearing in corporate behavior, including public-private-academia partnerships for supply chains and research and development. Based on results of on-site reporting from policymakers, experts, and business leaders in various countries and regions, we examine future prospects.

<Additional Articles>

◇ The Current State of the Tohoku Semiconductor Ecosystem (Part 2) Research and Development Foundation and International Collaboration

**[Special Feature] Exploring the Potential of Japanese Pop Culture in Africa <Additional Articles> **

Africa's population is expected to reach 1.47 billion in 2025. Population growth is projected to continue, with expansion of the local market anticipated. The median age is approximately 19 years, with many young people. With the spread of video streaming platforms, more young people are enjoying Japanese anime. Furthermore, events are held throughout Africa, with passionate fans engaging in cosplay. This special feature explains trends in local anime and gaming industries in Africa and examines the potential of Japanese pop culture.

<Additional Articles>

◇ How Japanese Idols Were Received in Africa

****[Special Feature] The Frontlines of Universities Producing Highly Skilled Foreign Talent
<Additional Articles>****

In recent years, Japan's talent recruitment has remained a seller's market. In particular, the shortage of science and engineering talent is serious, and companies are increasingly looking to foreign talent. On the other hand, approximately 70% of domestic international students are in liberal arts programs, with few in science and engineering. Given this situation, interest is also growing in international students pursuing science and engineering education in English and science and engineering talent enrolled in overseas universities. Additionally, regardless of major, more companies are expressing interest in hiring overseas university students studying Japanese. This special feature covers science and engineering talent interested in employment in Japan and Japanese language learners.